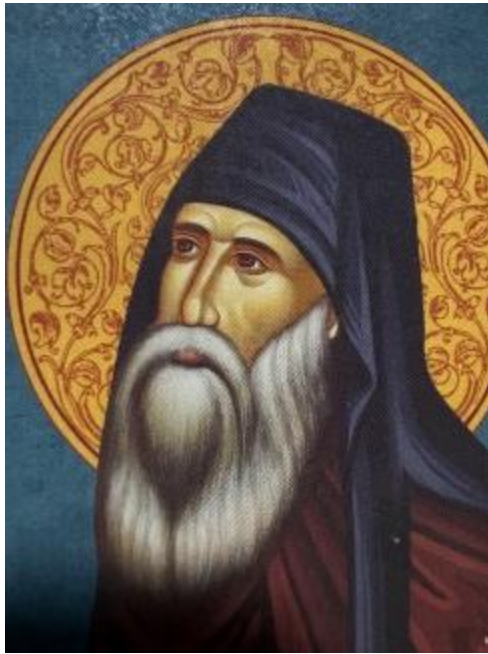




Vigil Service for
Our Venerable Father
Silouan the Athonite

The service begins with the lighting level in the temple low. The priest, vested in exorasson, epitrachelion and phelonion, blesses the incense, saying in a quiet voice:

Blessed is our God, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

The priest, preceded by the deacon (or subdeacon or reader if no deacon is present) carrying a lighted candle, censes the holy table. The priest exits the sanctuary through the north door, and does the great censuring of the entire church while the chanters slowly chant in Tone 8:

I shall go into Thy house; I shall worship toward Thy holy temple in fear of Thee, O Lord.

After the censuring, the priest enters the sanctuary through the holy doors and stands before the holy table. The candle-bearer stands on the east side of the holy table. At the end of the hymn and censuring, the deacon stands in the center of the solea.

Deacon: Bless, master!

Great Vespers

The priest begins Great Vespers by making the sign of the cross with the censer over the gospel book at the altar.

Priest: Glory to the holy, consubstantial, life-giving and undivided Trinity, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Reader: Amen.

Priest: Glory to thee, our God, glory to thee.

O heavenly King, the Comforter, Spirit of Truth, Who art in all places, and fillest all things, Treasury of good things, and Giver of life, come, and dwell in us, and cleanse us from every stain; and save our souls, O good One.

Reader: Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal: have mercy on us. (*thrice*)

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

All-holy Trinity, have mercy on us. Lord, cleanse us from our sins. Master, pardon our iniquities. Holy One, visit and heal our infirmities for thy name's sake.

Lord, have mercy. (*thrice*)

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name; thy kingdom come; thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread; and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

Priest: For Thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit; now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Reader: Amen.

Priest: For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit; now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Reader: Amen.

Come, let us worship and fall down before God our King.
Come, let us worship and fall down before Christ, our King and our God.
Come, let us worship and fall down before Christ Himself, our King and our God.

During the reading of Psalm 103, the priest removes his phelonion and quietly reads the seven prayers at the lighting of the lamps (The Liturgikon, fourth edition, 17; The Archdiocesan Service Book, 2).

THE PSALM OF INTRODUCTION—PSALM 103

Reader: Bless the Lord, O my soul; O Lord my God, Thou hast been magnified exceedingly. Confession and majesty hast Thou put on, Who coverest Thyself with light as with a garment, Who stretchest out the heaven as it were a curtain; Who supporteth His chambers in the waters, Who appointeth the clouds for His ascent, Who walketh upon the wings of the winds, Who maketh His angels spirits, and His ministers a flame of fire.

Who establisheth the earth in the sureness thereof; it shall not be turned back forever and ever. The abyss like a garment is His mantle; upon the mountains shall the waters stand. At Thy rebuke they will flee, at the voice of Thy thunder shall they be afraid.

The mountains rise up and the plains sink down, unto the place where Thou hast established them. Thou appointedst a bound that they shall not pass, neither return to cover the earth. He sendeth forth springs in the valleys; between the mountains will the waters run. They shall give drink to all the beasts of the field; the wild asses will wait to quench their thirst. Beside them will the birds of the heaven lodge, from the midst of the rocks will they give voice.

He watereth the mountains from His chambers; the earth shall be satisfied with the fruit of Thy works. He causeth the grass to grow for the cattle, and green herb for the service of men, to bring forth bread out of the earth; and wine maketh glad the heart of man. To make his face cheerful with oil; and bread strengtheneth man's heart.

The trees of the plain shall be satisfied, the cedars of Lebanon, which Thou hast planted. There the sparrows make their nests; the house of the heron is chief among them. The high mountains are a refuge for the harts, and so is the rock for the hares.

He hath made the moon for seasons; the sun knoweth his going down. Thou appointedst the darkness, and there was the night, wherein all the beasts of the forest will go abroad; young lions roaring after their prey, and seeking their food from God. The sun ariseth, and they are gathered together, and they lay them down in their dens. Man shall go forth unto his work, and to his labor until the evening. How magnified are Thy works, O Lord! In wisdom hast Thou made them all.

The earth is filled with Thy creation. So is this great and spacious sea, therein are things creeping innumerable, small living creatures with the great. There go the ships; there this dragon, whom Thou hast made to play therein. All things wait on Thee, to give them their food in due season; when Thou givest it them, they will gather it. When Thou openest Thy hand, all things shall be filled with goodness; when Thou turnest away Thy face, they shall be troubled. Thou wilt take their spirit, and they shall cease; and unto their dust shall they return. Thou wilt send forth Thy Spirit, and they shall be created; and Thou shalt renew the face of the earth.

Let the glory of the Lord be unto the ages; the Lord will rejoice in His works. Who looketh on the earth and maketh it tremble, Who toucheth the mountains and they smoke. I will sing unto the Lord throughout my life, I will chant to my God for as long as I have my being.

May my words be sweet unto Him; I will rejoice in the Lord. O that sinners would cease from the earth, and they that work iniquity, that they should be no more. Bless the Lord, O my soul.

The sun knoweth his going down. Thou appointedst the darkness, and there was the night. How magnified are Thy works, O Lord! In wisdom hast Thou made them all.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia. Glory to Thee, O God. (*thrice*)

O our God and our Hope, glory to Thee.

THE GREAT LITANY

Deacon: In peace, let us pray to the Lord.

The choir responds "Lord, have mercy" to each petition until noted.

For the peace from above and the salvation of our souls, let us pray to the Lord.

For the peace of the whole world, the good estate of the holy churches of God and the union of all, let us pray to the Lord.

For this holy house and those who with faith, reverence and fear of God enter therein, let us pray to the Lord.

For our father and metropolitan, N., (our bishop, N.,) the honorable presbytery, the diaconate in Christ, all the clergy and the people, let us pray to the Lord.

For our country, its president (or appropriate head of state), civil authorities and armed forces, let us pray to the Lord.

For this city and every city and countryside and the faithful who dwell therein, let us pray to the Lord.

For healthful seasons, abundance of the fruits of the earth and peaceful times, let us pray to the Lord.

For travelers by sea, by land and by air, the sick, the suffering, the captive, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord.

For our deliverance from all tribulation, wrath, danger and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: For unto thee are due all glory, honor and worship, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

SELECTIONS FROM THE FIRST KATHISMA OF THE PSALTER

****End each verse with "Alleluia."****

- + Blessed is the man that hath not walked in the counsel of the ungodly, nor stood in the way of sinners, nor sat in the seat of the pestilent.
- + But his will is rather in the law of the Lord, and in His law will he meditate day and night.
- + And he shall be like the tree which is planted by the streams of the waters.
- + Which shall bring forth its fruit in its season; and its leaf shall not fall, and all things whatsoever he may do shall prosper.
- + Not so are the ungodly, not so; but rather they are like the chaff which the wind doth hurl away from the face of the earth.
- + For this reason shall the ungodly not stand up in judgment, nor sinners in the council of the righteous.
- + For the Lord knows the way of the righteous, and the way of the ungodly shall perish.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia. Glory to Thee, O God. (*thrice*)

O our God and our Hope, glory to Thee.

THE LITTLE LITANY

Deacon: Again and again, in peace, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: For thine is the might, and thine is the kingdom, and the power and the glory, of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

"LORD, I HAVE CRIED" IN TONE ONE

Choir: Lord, I have cried unto Thee, hearken unto me; hearken unto me, O Lord.
Lord, I have cried unto Thee, hearken unto me; attend to the voice of my supplication when I cry unto Thee; hearken unto me, O Lord.

Choir: Let my prayer be set forth as incense before Thee, the lifting up of my hands as an evening sacrifice; hearken unto me, O Lord.

- + Set, O Lord, a watch before my mouth, and a door of enclosure round about my lips.

- + Incline not my heart unto words of evil, to make excuse with excuses in sins.
- + With men that work iniquity; and I will not join with their chosen.
- + The righteous man will chasten me with mercy and reprove me; as for the oil of the sinner, let it not anoint my head.
- + For yet more is my prayer in the presence of their pleasures; swallowed up near by the rock have their judges been.
- + They shall hear my words, for they be sweetened; as a clod of earth is broken upon the earth, so have their bones been scattered nigh unto hades.
- + For unto Thee, O Lord, O Lord, are mine eyes, in Thee have I hoped; take not my soul away.
- + Keep me from the snare which they have laid for me, and from the stumbling-blocks of them that work iniquity.
- + The sinners shall fall into their own net; I am alone until I pass by.
- + With my voice unto the Lord have I cried, with my voice unto the Lord have I made supplication.
- + I will pour out before Him my supplication, mine affliction before Him will I declare.
- + When my spirit was fainting within me, then Thou knewest my paths.
- + In this way wherein I have walked they hid for me a snare.
- + I looked upon my right hand, and beheld, and there was none that did know me.
- + Flight hath failed me, and there is none that watcheth out for my soul.
- + I have cried unto Thee, O Lord; I said: Thou art my hope, my portion art Thou in the land of the living.
- + Attend unto my supplication, for I am brought very low.
- + Deliver me from them that persecute me, for they are stronger than I.

Verse 10. *Bring my soul out of prison, that I may praise Thy Name.*

Verse 9. *The righteous shall wait for me until Thou recompense me.*

Verse 8. *Out of the depths have I cried to Thee, O Lord, Lord hear my voice.*

Verse 7. *Let Thine ears be attentive to the voice of my supplication.*

[For St Silouan in Tone One \(**Thou art the joy**\)](#)

Verse 6. *If Thou, O Lord, shouldest mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand? For with Thee there is forgiveness.*

The newly sprung son of Athos let us all hymn with joy, * who hath been rightly added * to the Saints' congregation. * For, he reflected purely their virtues and love: * Wondrous father, blest Silouan, * who was vouchsafed to behold God Whose Grace he sought * and made manifest to all the world.

Verse 5. *Because of Thy name have I waited for Thee, O Lord; my soul hath waited upon Thy word, my soul hath hoped in the Lord.*

For God alone didst thou long from thy youth, O Silouan, * and thou didst firmly hold Him * not alone by mere knowledge, * but also by the Spirit's ineffable grace; * and thou off'rest up fervent prayer * that all the peoples and nations upon the earth * may be filled with gifts of

grace from God.

Verse 4. *From the morning watch until night, from the morning watch let Israel trust in the Lord.*

As spake the Law-giver Christ Who can never speak a lie: * Within a man abideth * the true Kingdom of Heaven. * Thou, O father Silouan didst closely explore * these good words and didst find them as * pure dew upon the rich, fertile earth of thy heart * thus increasing a most godly seed.

For St. Silouan in Tone Two (***With what fair crowns***))

Verse 3. *For with the Lord there is mercy and with Him is abundant redemption, and He will deliver Israel from all his iniquities.*

What songs shall we now sing unto thee, * giving thanks to thee, glorious father, * rendering therein all that we owe thee? * For by thy writings our thirst is quenched, * and we have received from thee great riches: * thy teaching to keep the mind in the abyss of hell, * yet, while not ever succumbing to despair therein. * Through this may we find salvation, * being filled with godly hope. * And now by the Holy Spirit, * art thou, O blest Silouan, * confirmed as a guide for all the world.

Verse 2. *Praise the Lord, all ye nations; praise Him, all ye people.*

Valiant souls which have suffered a fall * can by means of it find restoration. * This is their foundation for knowing God; * it is the enemy's vanquishment. * For when they subject the energy of * their spirit * to yearning after those things heavenly, * completely * directing all their steps t'wards God alone, * then they partake in abundance * of the uncreated * gift of Grace beyond all knowledge. * The old man have they put off, * and they are shown forth to be like Christ.

Verse 1. *For His mercy is great toward us, and the truth of the Lord endureth forever.*

Longing after the life lived by monks * was enkindled in thy soul, O Father, * when the Theotokos bestowed on thee * repentance as a salvific grace. * She censured thee saying: I am not pleased * with thy life, * for dreaming, thou hadst swallowed down a snake. * For this cause, * O blessed Silouan, thou didst follow * the way of excellent virtue * on the Holy Mountain, * there thou foundest weeping to be * the key that doth open wide * the bountiful mercies of the Lord.

[DOXASTICON FOR ST. SILOUAN IN TONE SIX](#)

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Christ the Lord, the most compassionate God, hath given us a new comfort in the latter days: the most blessed Silouan who is a living gospel and unspotted image of the Savior. As we look to him as our father, we are replenished with spiritual joy; and taking him for our sure guide, we journey unwavering toward God, to Whom we cry with the voice of thanksgiving: Glory be to Thee, O Lord, Who in the last times hast shown forth Thy saints as bright, shining stars, through whom we find illumination in Thee, the Sun that knoweth no eventide.

[THEOTOKION IN TONE SIX](#)

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Who would not call thee blest, O all-holy Virgin? Who would not praise thine untravailing giving of birth? For the Only-begotten Son, Who shone forth from the Father timelessly, hath come forth from thee, the pure one, having become ineffably incarnate, being God by nature and becoming man by nature for our sake; not that He was divided into two persons, but that

He is known in two unmingled natures. Him do thou beseech, O august and all-blessed one, to have mercy on our souls.

The priests don their phelonia. The choir sings the Theotokion while the clergy makes the entrance with the censer.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord. Lord, have mercy.

Priest: In the evening and in the morning and at noonday we praise Thee, we bless Thee, we give thanks unto Thee, and we pray unto Thee, O Master of all, Lord Who lovest mankind: Direct our prayer as incense before Thee, and incline not our hearts unto words or thoughts of evil, but deliver us from all who seek after our souls. For unto Thee, O Lord, Lord, are our eyes, and in Thee have we hoped. Put us not to shame, O our God. For unto Thee are due all glory, honor, and worship: to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit; now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Deacon: Amen.

(When the clergy reach the center of the solea, the first part of the great censuring begins. After the first part of the great censuring is completed, this next dialogue occurs QUIETLY.)

Deacon: Bless, father, the Holy Entrance.

Priest: Blessed is the entrance to Thy Holy Place, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Deacon: Wisdom! Stand upright!

O GLADSOME LIGHT

O gladsome Light of the holy glory of the immortal, heavenly, holy and blessed Father: O Jesus Christ. Lo now that we have come to the setting of the sun, as we behold the evening light, we hymn Thee: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, God. Meet it is for Thee at all times to be magnified by joyous voices, O Son of God and Giver of life. Wherefore the whole world doth glorify Thee.

The clergy return to the sanctuary.

Deacon: The evening prokeimenon!

WEDNESDAY PROKEIMENON IN TONE FIVE

Choir: O God, in Thy Name save me, and in Thy strength do Thou judge me. (twice)

Verse. O God, hearken unto my prayer, give ear unto the words of my mouth.

Choir: O God, in Thy Name save me, and in Thy strength do Thou judge me.

THE OLD TESTAMENT READINGS

The First Reading

Reader: The reading from the Wisdom of Solomon. (3:1-9)

Deacon: Wisdom. Let us attend.

Reader: The souls of the righteous are in the hands of God, and there shall no torment touch them. In the sight of the unwise they seemed to die, and their departure is taken for misery, and their going from us to be utter destruction, but they are in peace. For though they be punished in the sight of men, yet is their hope full of immortality. And having been a little chastised, they shall be greatly rewarded; for God proved them and found them worthy for Himself. As gold in the furnace hath He tried them, and received them as a burnt offering. And in the time of their visitation they shall shine, and run to and fro like sparks among the stubble. They shall judge nations and have dominion over peoples, and their Lord shall reign unto the

ages. They that put their trust in Him shall understand the truth; and such as be faithful in love shall abide with Him; for grace and mercy is in His Saints, and visitation among His elect. All the words of my mouth are in righteousness; there is nothing forward or perverse in them. They are all plain to him that understandeth, and right to them that find knowledge. For I will teach you the truth, that your hope may be in the Lord and ye may be filled with the Spirit.

The Second Reading

Reader: The reading from the Wisdom of Solomon (4:7-15).

Deacon: Wisdom. Let us attend.

Reader: Though the righteous happen to die, yet shall he be in rest; for honorable age is not that which standeth in length of time, nor that which is measured by number of years. But wisdom is the gray hair unto men, and an unspotted life is old age. He pleased God, and was beloved of Him, so that living among sinners he was translated. Yea, speedily was he taken away, lest that wickedness should alter his understanding, or deceit beguile his soul; for the fascination of wickedness doth obscure things that are honest, and the wandering of desire doth undermine the simple mind. He being made perfect in a short time, fulfilled a long time; for his soul pleased the Lord; therefore hastened He to take him away from among the wicked. This the people saw, and understood it not, neither did they lay this up in their minds, that His grace and mercy is with His Saints, and that He doth visit His chosen.

The Third Reading

Reader: The reading from the Prophecy of Joel (2:28-32).

Deacon: Wisdom. Let us attend.

Reader: Thus saith the Lord: And it shall come to pass afterward, that I will pour out My Spirit upon all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall prophecy, your old men shall dream dreams, your young men shall see visions; and also upon the servants and upon the handmaids in those days will I pour out My Spirit. And I will show wonders in the heavens and in the earth – blood and fire and pillars of smoke. The sun shall be turned into darkness and the moon into blood, before the great and terrible day of the Lord come.

THE LITANY OF FERVENT SUPPLICATION

Deacon: Let us all say with our whole soul and with our whole mind, let us say:

The choir responds “Lord, have mercy” to the first two petitions.

O Lord Almighty, the God of our fathers, we pray thee hearken and have mercy.

Have mercy on us, O God, according to thy great mercy, we pray thee, hearken and have mercy.

The choir responds “Lord, have mercy” (thrice) to this and the remaining petitions until noted.

Again we pray for all pious and Orthodox Christians.

Again we pray for our father and metropolitan, N., (and our bishop, N.).

Again we pray for our brethren: the priests, hieromonks, deacons, hierodeacons and monastics and all our brotherhood in Christ.

Again we pray for mercy, life, peace, health, salvation, visitation, pardon and remission of sins for (the servants of God, NN., and) all Orthodox Christians of true worship, who live and dwell in this community.

Again we pray for the blessed and ever-memorable founders of this holy church (and for the servants of God, NN.,) and all of our fathers and brethren, the Orthodox departed this life before us, who here and in all the world lie asleep in the Lord.

Again we pray for those who bear fruit and do good works in this holy and all-venerable temple, those who serve and those who sing and all the people here present, who await thy great and rich mercy.

Priest: For thou art a merciful God and lovest mankind, and unto thee we ascribe glory, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

THE EVENING PRAYER

People: Vouchsafe, O Lord, to keep us this evening without sin. Blessed art Thou, O Lord, the God of our fathers, and praised and glorified is Thy Name forever. Amen.

Let Thy mercy be upon us, O Lord, even as we have set our hope on Thee. Blessed art Thou, O Lord; teach me Thy statutes. Blessed art Thou, O Master; make me to understand Thy statutes. Blessed art Thou, O Holy One; enlighten me with Thy statutes.

Thy mercy, O Lord, endureth forever. O despise not the works of Thy hands. To Thee belongeth worship, to Thee belongeth praise, to Thee belongeth glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit; now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

THE LITANY OF SUPPLICATION

Deacon: Let us complete our evening prayer unto the Lord.

The choir responds "Lord, have mercy" to the first two petitions.

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

That the whole evening may be perfect, holy, peaceful and sinless, let us ask of the Lord.

The choir responds "Grant this, O Lord" to this and the remaining petitions until noted.

An angel of peace, a faithful guide, a guardian of our souls and bodies, let us ask of the Lord.

Pardon and remission of our sins and transgressions, let us ask of the Lord.

All things good and profitable for our souls and peace for the world, let us ask of the Lord.

That we may complete the remaining time of our life in peace and repentance, let us ask of the Lord.

A Christian ending to our life, painless, blameless, peaceful, and a good defense before the fearful judgment seat of Christ, let us ask.

Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: For thou art a good God and lovest mankind, and unto thee we ascribe glory, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

THE PEACE

Priest: Peace be to all.

Choir: And to thy spirit.

Deacon: Let us bow our heads unto the Lord.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

All bow their heads as the priest says the following prayer:

Priest: O Lord our God, Who didst bow the heavens and come down for the salvation of mankind: Look upon Thy servants and Thine inheritance; for unto Thee, the fearful Judge Who yet lovest mankind, have Thy servants bowed their heads and submissively inclined their necks, awaiting not help from men but entreating Thy mercy and looking confidently for Thy salvation. Guard them at all times, both during this present evening and in the approaching night, from every foe, from all adverse powers of the devil, and from vain thoughts and from evil imaginations.

Blessed and glorified be the might of Thy kingdom: of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit; now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

HYMNS AT THE LITIA PROCESSION

For St. Silouan in Tone Five

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

In the Holy Spirit thou didst see the living Christ and didst receive an abundance of life, O most holy Silouan. Being conformed unto His image, thou didst strengthen many men who had grown weak through grievous sins. Having lived by experience the resurrection of the soul and being illumined by the light of Tabor, thou didst make faith in God more steadfast in the world. Wherefore, O father, thou art become a preacher according to God's purpose for thee. Receive from us these halting words of thankfulness and by thine unsurpassable prayers grant us in return the grace of the Spirit.

THEOTOKION IN TONE FIVE

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

We the faithful bless thee, O Virgin Theotokos, and we glorify thee, as is meet and proper: O unshaken city, impregnable battlement, invincible protection, and sheltering refuge for our souls.

As the chanters sing the Litia hymns, the clergy exit the sanctuary with the festal icon preceded by the acolytes and go to the narthex. The icon is carried three times around the stand where it is then placed, the deacon going before the priest with candle and censer. Then the clergy venerate the icon.

The Litia

Deacon: Have mercy upon us, O God, according to thy great mercy, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

The choir responds “Lord, have mercy” ([thrice](#)) to this and the remaining petitions until noted.

Again we pray for all pious and Orthodox Christians.

Again we pray for our father and metropolitan, N., (our bishop, N.,) and all our brotherhood in Christ.

Again we pray for every Christian soul, afflicted and weary, in need of God’s mercies and help; for the protection of this holy house and those who sing therein and the people here present; for the peace and stability of the whole world; for the good estate of the holy Churches of God; for the salvation and help of our fathers and brethren who with diligence and fear of God labor and serve; for those who are abroad; for those who travel by sea, by land and by air; for the healing of those who lie in infirmity; for the deliverance of captives; for those imprisoned and in danger; for our brethren who are serving and who are remembered for their labor, and for all who await the mercies of God, let us say:

Again we pray for mercy, life, peace, health, salvation, visitation, pardon and remission of sins for the servants of God, the parishioners, members of the parish council and organizations, donors and benefactors of this holy temple and those who celebrate this holy feast (and for his servants, NN., who are offering these loaves).

Again we pray that he may keep this holy church and this city and every city and countryside from wrath, famine, plague, earthquake, flood, fire, the sword, foreign invasion, civil war and sudden death; that our good God, who loveth mankind, will be gracious, favorable and conciliatory and will turn away and dispel all the wrath stirred up against us and all sickness and may deliver us from his righteous chastisement which impendeth against us and have mercy on us.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. ([forty times](#))

Deacon: Again we pray that the Lord our God may hearken unto the voice of the supplication of us sinners and have mercy upon us.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. (*thrice*)

Priest: Hear us, O God our Savior, the Hope of all the ends of the earth and of those who are far off upon the sea; and be gracious, be gracious, O Master, toward our sins, and have mercy upon us. For thou art a merciful God and lovest mankind, and unto thee we ascribe glory, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

THE PEACE

Priest: Peace be to all.

Choir: And to thy spirit.

Deacon: Let us bow our heads unto the Lord.

Choir: To thee, O Lord.

THE INTERCESSION

Priest: O Master, plenteous in mercy, Lord Jesus Christ our God, through the intercessions of our all-immaculate Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary; by the might of the precious and life-giving cross; by the protection of the honorable bodiless powers of heaven; at the supplication of the honorable, glorious Prophet, Forerunner and Baptist John; of the holy, glorious, all-laudable and foremost of the apostles, Peter and Paul, and of all the holy apostles; of our fathers among the saints, great hierarchs and ecumenical teachers Basil the Great, Gregory the Theologian and John Chrysostom; Athanasios, Cyril and John the Merciful, patriarchs of Alexandria; Nicholas of Myra in Lycia, Spyridon of Trimythous and Nektarios of Pentapolis, the wonder-workers; of our fathers among the saints Tikhon, patriarch of Moscow, and Raphael, bishop of Brooklyn; of the holy, glorious great martyrs George the Trophy-bearer, Demetrios the Myrrh-streaming, Theodore the Soldier, Theodore the General and Menas the Wonderworker; of the hieromartyrs Ignatius the God-bearer of Antioch, Charalampos and Eleftherios; of the holy, glorious and great women martyrs Thekla—whose memory we now celebrate—Barbara, Anastasia, Katherine, Kyriaki, Photini, Marina, Paraskeva and Irene; of the holy glorious and right-victorious martyrs; of our venerable and God-bearing fathers who shone in the ascetic life; of St Silouan the Athonite patron and protector of this holy community, whose memory we keep this day; of the holy and righteous ancestors of God, Joachim and Anna; of the Juvenaly & Peter the Aleut, New Martyrs of Alaska whose memory we celebrate; and of all thy saints,

Priest: Make our prayer acceptable;

The choir responds "Amen" for each part of the phrase.

Grant us forgiveness of our trespasses;

Shelter us under the shelter of thy wings;

Drive away from us every enemy and adversary;

Give peace to our life.

O Lord, have mercy on us and on thy world and save our souls, for thou art a merciful God and lovest mankind.

The clergy venerate the festal icon and process to the solea upon which the Artoklasia is prepared.

THE APOSTICHA FOR ST SILOUAN IN TONE FIVE (**Rejoice**)

Rejoice, thou who wast nurtured by God, * O wondrous Silouan, thou splendor of Russia's lands * and glory of Holy Athos and preacher of Grace divine * to the Church of Christ, and the restoration of * all those who have greatly sinned, * strength of those who now stand aright, * and ground in Christ for all despairing and weakened souls, * and a living book of humility for us all. * Wherefore, as we extol thee and entreat thee, O blessed saint, * grant that the all-holy Spirit may make His dwelling within our hearts, * through thine intercessions * before God, Whom thou hast glorified by thy holy life.

Verse 1. *With patience I waited patiently for the Lord, and He was attentive unto me, and He hearkened unto my supplication.*

Rejoice, thou who wast joined unto Christ, * by wondrous gifts of Grace which worked in thy lowly soul. * But thou couldst not bear it when this most awesome grace was removed, * for thou knewest that grace truly giveth life. * Rejoice, blessed saint, who sheddest thy blood in thy prayers to God, * in lamentation for the whole of creation, and * more especially for the dead, O thou friend of souls. * To give account of thy great life perplexeth us mightily, * for truly another breath of the Spirit breathed in thy very breast, * whereas, we thy children * are embroiled and ensnared in the busyness of life.

Verse 2. *And He brought me up out of the pit of misery and from the mire of clay.*

Rejoice, thou who dost scatter vain thoughts, * destroying all the evil spirits beguiling us: * Great glory of all Mount Athos, * thou who dost guide and protect * every soul preserving ceaseless watchfulness, * uniter of heart and mind, * to the senses, a ray of light, * thou sword that cuttest off the stirrings of raging pride, * radiant tabernacle of light unapproachable, * wherein thou hast kept hidden the unspeakable mysteries, * that which no eye hath beheld, nor the mind of man ever hath conceived, * thou mouth of the Lord God, * who declarest with a great voice the will of God to men.

DOXASTICON FOR ST. SILOUAN IN TONE EIGHT

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Receive this hymn of praise, O most-compassionate father, and reject it not. For though it be little, yet is it full of love. What words could suffice to laud thy wondrous life, O saint? For thou hast attained the height of the ascetics of old, and like the morning star thou leadest unto the knowledge of God souls gone astray in the dark night of sin. Thou teachest the world of the Holy Spirit, not through reasoning, but by thy life. Wherefore, we are filled with wonder at the sight of thee, O Silouan, and we bless the land that bore thee, and likewise thy spiritual homeland where thou wast filled with holiness. Make intercession unto the Lord for us, we beseech thee, thou new and great glory of Mount Athos and the whole world.

THEOTOKION IN TONE EIGHT

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O unwedded Virgin, who inexpressibly conceived God in the flesh, O Mother of the Most High God: Receive the petitions of thy suppliants, O all-blameless one. O thou who grantest unto all purification from offenses, receive now our entreaties, and beseech that we all be saved.

The Hymn of St. Simeon is traditionally said by the priest, but he may defer to the choir.

THE HYMN OF ST. SIMEON THE GOD-RECEIVER

Lord, now lettest thou Thy servant depart in peace, according to Thy word; for mine eyes have seen Thy salvation, which Thou hast prepared before the face of all people, a light to lighten the Gentiles and the glory of Thy people Israel.

THE TRISAGION PRAYERS

People: Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal: have mercy on us. (*thrice*)
Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.
All-holy Trinity, have mercy on us. Lord, cleanse us from our sins. Master, pardon our iniquities. Holy One, visit and heal our infirmities for thy name's sake.
Lord, have mercy. (*thrice*)
Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.
Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name; thy kingdom come; thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread; and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

Priest: For Thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit; now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The Artoklasia

APOLYTIKION FOR ST. SILOUAN IN TONE FOUR

By prayer thou didst receive Christ as thy teacher in the way of humility, and the Spirit bore witness to salvation in thy heart. Wherefore, all peoples called unto hope rejoice in this day of thy memorial, O sacred Father Silouan. Pray unto Christ our God for the salvation of our souls. (*twice*)

During the following theotokion, the priest censes around the table and icon stand once, with the deacon opposite him, holding a candle.

THEOTOKION IN TONE FIVE

Priest: O Theotokos and Virgin, full of grace, rejoice, O Mary; the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the Fruit of thy womb;

Choir: For thou hast borne the Savior of our souls.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

Priest: O Lord Jesus Christ our God, Who didst bless the five loaves in the wilderness and didst satisfy the five thousand therewith, thyself bless these loaves, this wheat, wine and oil, and multiply them in this city, in the houses of those who celebrate this feast and in all thy world, and sanctify the faithful who partake of

them. For it is Thou Who dost bless and sanctify all things, O Christ our God, and unto Thee do we ascribe glory, together with Thine unoriginate Father and Thine all-holy, good and life-giving Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

The priest kisses the top loaf and breaks it crosswise. The clergy sing the following troparion once, and then the choir sings it twice.

TROPARION IN TONE SEVEN

Rich men have turned poor and gone hungry; but they that seek the Lord shall not be deprived of any good thing.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

Priest: The blessing of the Lord and His mercy come upon you through His divine grace and love towards mankind, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

Thus ends the Great Vespers portion of the vigil. The clergy enter the sanctuary and the priests remove their phelonias.

Festal Orthros

Reader: Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, goodwill among men.
(*thrice*)

O Lord, Thou shalt open my lips, and my mouth shall declare Thy praise. (*twice*)

PSALM 3

O Lord, why are they multiplied that afflict me? Many rise up against me. Many say unto my soul: There is no salvation for him in his God. But Thou, O Lord, art my helper, my glory, and the lifter up of my head. I cried unto the Lord with my voice, and He heard me out of His holy mountain. I laid me down and slept; I awoke, for the Lord will help me. I will not be afraid of ten thousands of people that set themselves against me round about. Arise, O Lord, save me, O my God, for Thou hast smitten all who without cause are mine enemies; the teeth of sinners hast Thou broken. Salvation is of the Lord, and Thy blessing is upon Thy people.

I laid me down and slept; I awoke, for the Lord will help me.

PSALM 37

O Lord, rebuke me not in Thine anger, nor chasten me in Thy wrath. For Thine arrows are fastened in me, and Thou hast laid Thy hand heavily upon me. There is no healing in my flesh in the face of Thy wrath; and there is no peace in my bones in the face of my sins. For mine iniquities are risen higher than my head; as a heavy burden have they pressed heavily upon me. My bruises are become noisome and corrupt in the face of my folly. I have been wretched and utterly bowed down until the end; all the day long I went with downcast face. For my loins are filled with mocking, and there is no healing in my flesh. I am afflicted and humbled exceedingly, I have roared from the groaning of my heart. O Lord, before Thee is all my desire,

and my groaning is not hid from Thee. My heart is troubled, my strength hath failed me; and the light of mine eyes, even this is not with me. My friends and my neighbors drew nigh over against me and stood, and my nearest of kin stood afar off. And they that sought after my soul used violence; and they that sought evils for me spake vain things, and craftinesses all the day long did they meditate. But as for me, like a deaf man I heard them not, and was as a speechless man that openeth not his mouth. And I became as a man that heareth not, and that hath in his mouth no reproofs. For in Thee have I hoped, O Lord; Thou wilt hearken unto me, O Lord my God. For I said: Let never mine enemies rejoice over me; yea, when my feet were shaken, those men spake boastful words against me. For I am ready for scourges, and my sorrow is continually before me. For I will declare mine iniquity, and I will take heed concerning my sin. But mine enemies live and are made stronger than I, and they that hated me unjustly are multiplied. They that render me evil for good slandered me, because I pursued goodness. Forsake me not, O Lord my God, depart not from me. Be attentive unto my help, O Lord of my salvation.

Forsake me not, O Lord my God, depart not from me. Be attentive unto my help, O Lord of my salvation.

PSALM 62

O God, my God, unto Thee I rise early at dawn. My soul hath thirsted for Thee; how often hath my flesh longed after Thee in a land barren and untrodden and unwatered. So in the sanctuary have I appeared before Thee to see Thy power and Thy glory. For Thy mercy is better than lives; my lips shall praise Thee. So shall I bless Thee in my life, and in Thy name will I lift up my hands. As with marrow and fatness let my soul be filled, and with lips rejoicing shall my mouth praise Thee. If I remembered Thee on my bed, at the dawn I meditated on Thee. For Thou art become my helper; in the shelter of Thy wings will I rejoice. My soul hath cleaved after Thee; Thy right hand hath been quick to help me. But as for these, in vain have they sought after my soul; they shall go into the nethermost parts of the earth, they shall be surrendered unto the edge of the sword; portions for foxes shall they be. But the king shall be glad in God, everyone shall be praised that sweareth by Him; for the mouth of them is stopped that speak unjust things.

At the dawn I meditated on Thee. For Thou art become my helper; in the shelter of Thy wings will I rejoice. My soul hath cleaved after Thee; Thy right hand hath been quick to help me.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia. Glory to Thee, O God. (*thrice*)

Lord, have mercy. (*thrice*)

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

PSALM 87

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O Lord God of my salvation, by day have I cried and by night before Thee. Let my prayer come before Thee, bow down Thine ear unto my supplication, for filled with evils is my soul, and my life unto Hades hath drawn nigh. I am counted with them that go down into the pit; I am become as a man without help, free among the dead, like the bodies of the slain that sleep in the grave, whom Thou rememberest no more, and they are cut off from Thy hand. They laid me in the lowest pit, in darkness and in the shadow of death. Against me is Thine anger made strong, and all Thy billows hast Thou brought upon me. Thou hast removed my friends afar

from me; they have made me an abomination unto themselves. I have been delivered up, and have not come forth; mine eyes are grown weak from poverty. I have cried unto Thee, O Lord, the whole day long; I have stretched out my hands unto Thee. Nay, for the dead wilt Thou work wonders? Or shall physicians raise them up that they may give thanks unto Thee? Nay, shall any in the grave tell of Thy mercy, and of Thy truth in that destruction? Nay, shall Thy wonders be known in that darkness, and Thy righteousness in that land that is forgotten? But as for me, unto Thee, O Lord, have I cried; and in the morning shall my prayer come before Thee. Wherefore, O Lord, dost Thou cast off my soul and turnest Thy face away from me? A poor man am I, and in troubles from my youth; yea, having been exalted, I was humbled and brought to distress. Thy furies have passed upon me, and Thy terrors have sorely troubled me. They came round about me like water, all the day long they compassed me about together. Thou hast removed afar from me friend and neighbor, and mine acquaintances because of my misery.

O Lord God of my salvation, by day have I cried and by night before Thee. Let my prayer come before Thee, bow down Thine ear unto my supplication.

PSALM 102

Bless the Lord, O my soul, and all that is within me bless His holy name. Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all that He hath done for thee, Who is gracious unto all thine iniquities, Who ealth all thine infirmities, Who redeemeth thy life from corruption, Who crowneth thee with mercy and compassion, Who fulfilleth thy desire with good things; thy youth shall be renewed as the eagle's. The Lord performeth deeds of mercy, and executeth judgment for all them that are wronged. He hath made His ways known unto Moses, unto the sons of Israel the things that He hath willed. Compassionate and merciful is the Lord, long-suffering and plenteous in mercy; not unto the end will He be angered; neither unto eternity will He be wroth. Not according to our iniquities hath He dealt with us, neither according to our sins hath He rewarded us. For according to the height of heaven from the earth, the Lord hath made His mercy to prevail over them that fear Him. As far as the east is from the west, so far hath He removed our iniquities from us. Like as a father hath compassion upon his sons, so hath the Lord had compassion upon them that fear Him; for He knoweth whereof we are made, He hath remembered that we are dust. As for man, his days are as the grass; as a flower of the field, so shall he blossom forth. For when the wind is passed over it, then it shall be gone, and no longer will it know the place thereof. But the mercy of the Lord is from eternity, even unto eternity, upon them that fear Him. And His righteousness is upon sons of sons, upon them that keep His testament and remember His commandments to do them. The Lord in heaven hath prepared His throne, and His kingdom ruleth over all. Bless the Lord, all ye His angels, mighty in strength, that perform His word, to hear the voice of His words. Bless the Lord, all ye His hosts, His ministers that do His will. Bless the Lord, all ye His works, in every place of His dominion. Bless the Lord, O my soul.

In every place of His dominion, bless the Lord, O my soul.

PSALM 142

O Lord, hear my prayer, give ear unto my supplication in Thy truth; hearken unto me in Thy righteousness. And enter not into judgment with Thy servant, for in Thy sight shall no man living be justified. For the enemy hath persecuted my soul; he hath humbled my life down to the earth. He hath sat me in darkness as those that have been long dead, and my spirit within me is become despondent; within me my heart is troubled. I remembered days of old, I meditated on all Thy works, I pondered on the creations of Thy hands. I stretched forth my hands unto Thee; my soul thirsteth after Thee like a waterless land. Quickly hear me, O Lord;

my spirit hath fainted away. Turn not Thy face away from me, lest I be like unto them that go down into the pit. Cause me to hear Thy mercy in the morning; for in Thee have I put my hope. Cause me to know, O Lord, the way wherein I should walk; for unto Thee have I lifted up my soul. Rescue me from mine enemies, O Lord; unto Thee have I fled for refuge. Teach me to do Thy will, for Thou art my God. Thy good Spirit shall lead me in the land of uprightness; for Thy name's sake, O Lord, shalt Thou quicken me. In Thy righteousness shalt Thou bring my soul out of affliction, and in Thy mercy shalt Thou utterly destroy mine enemies. And Thou shalt cut off all them that afflict my soul, for I am Thy servant.

Hearken unto me, O Lord, in Thy righteousness and enter not into judgment with Thy servant. (*twice*)

Thy good Spirit shall lead me in the land of uprightness.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit; both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia. Glory to Thee, O God. (*thrice*)

O our God and our Hope, glory to Thee!

THE GREAT LITANY

Deacon: In peace, let us pray to the Lord.

The choir responds "Lord, have mercy" to each petition until noted.

For the peace from above and the salvation of our souls, let us pray to the Lord.

For the peace of the whole world, the good estate of the holy churches of God and the union of all, let us pray to the Lord.

For this holy house and those who with faith, reverence and fear of God enter therein, let us pray to the Lord.

For our father and metropolitan, N., (our bishop, N.,) the honorable presbytery, the diaconate in Christ, all the clergy and the people, let us pray to the Lord.

For our country, its president (or appropriate head of state), civil authorities and armed forces, let us pray to the Lord.

For this city and every city and countryside and the faithful who dwell therein, let us pray to the Lord.

For healthful seasons, abundance of the fruits of the earth and peaceful times, let us pray to the Lord.

For travelers by sea, by land and by air, the sick, the suffering, the captive, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord.

For our deliverance from all tribulation, wrath, danger and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: For unto Thee are due all glory, honor and worship, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

“GOD IS THE LORD” IN TONE FOUR

Choir: God is the Lord and hath appeared unto us. Blessed is He that cometh in the Name of the Lord.

Verse 1. O give thanks unto the Lord and call upon His Holy Name. (*Refrain*)

Verse 2. All nations compassed me about: but in the Name of the Lord will I destroy them. (*Refrain*)

Verse 3. This is the Lord’s doing; it is marvelous in our eyes. (*Refrain*)

APOLYTIKION OF ST. SILOUAN IN TONE FOUR

By prayer thou didst receive Christ as thy teacher in the way of humility, and the Spirit bore witness to salvation in thy heart. Wherefore, all peoples called unto hope rejoice in this day of thy memorial, O sacred Father Silouan. Pray unto Christ our God for the salvation of our souls.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. (repeat above)

THEOTOKION IN TONE FOUR

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

The mystery hidden from eternity and unknown to the Angels is made manifest through thee, O Theotokos, to those on earth. God became incarnate in an unmingled union and for our sake hath submitted willingly to the Cross, whereby He hath raised up the first-fashioned man and hath saved our souls from death.

The kathisma of the Psalter may be read here (numbering is LXX): Monday (#4, Psalms 24-31); Tuesday (#7, Psalms 46-54); Wednesday (#10, Psalms 70-76); Thursday (#13, Psalms 91-100); Friday (#19, Psalms 134-142); Saturday (#16, Psalms 109-117). The clergy take kairon, but the deacon stands at his usual place on the solea to say the little litany.

THE LITTLE LITANY

Deacon: Again and again, in peace, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most-blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints: let us commend ourselves and each other, and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: For thine is the might, and thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

POETIC KATHISMATA FOR ST SILOUAN

First Kathisma in Tone One (***The soldiers standing guard***)

Since thou wast filled with love both for God and thy neighbor, * thou therefore, didst converse in the knowledge of myst'ries, * and thou didst foresee the future as present, O blessed Saint. * And as we now ponder on thy life which was grace-filled, * God-wise Silouan * with one accord we all cry out: * O Christ, glory be to Thee.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. (repeat above)

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

What comfort, peace and joy, what release from affliction * is given to the soul in thy name, Virgin Mary? * For them that with faith invoke thy great mercy, O Bride of God! * Wherefore, we, with hearts redeemed from bondage of sorrow, * cry to thee with gladness and unbounded thanksgiving: * Rejoice, O thou full of Grace.

The kathisma of the Psalter may be read here (numbering is LXX): Monday (#5, Psalms 32-36); Tuesday (#8, Psalms 55-63); Wednesday (#11, Psalms 77-84); Thursday (#14, Psalms 101-104); Friday (#20, Psalms 143-150); Saturday (#17, Psalm 118). Then, the deacon stands at his usual place on the solea.

THE LITTLE LITANY

Deacon: Again and again, in peace, etc.

Priest: Blessed and glorified be the might of thy kingdom of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

Second Kathisma in Tone Four (***Thou Who wast raised***)

Today thy monastery shineth in gladness, * for she hath brought thee up and then put thee forward, * presenting thee, O Father, as an offering unto Christ. * Thus, the Church doth take delight in thy good conversation. * And thou art our advocate * who art ever entreating * before the Face of God, where thou dost pray * for the salvation * of those who are praising thee.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. (repeat above)

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O Theotokos, we shall not cease from speaking * of all thy mighty acts, all we the unworthy ones; * for if thou hadst not stood to intercede for us, * who would have delivered us * from such numerous dangers? * Who would have preserved us all * until now in true freedom? * O Lady, we shall not turn away from thee; * for thou dost always save thy servants from all manner of grief.

The lights are turned up, with the exception of the central chandelier.

THE POLYELEOS, PART I: PSALM 134

End each verse with "Alleluia."

1. Praise ye the Lord. Praise ye the name of the Lord; praise him, O ye servants of the Lord.
2. Ye that stand in the house of the Lord, in the courts of the house of our God.
3. Praise the Lord; for the Lord is good: sing praises unto His Name; for it is pleasant.
4. For the Lord hath chosen Jacob unto Himself, and Israel for His peculiar treasure.

5. For I know that the Lord is great, and that our Lord is above all gods.
6. Whatsoever the Lord pleased, that did He in Heaven, and in earth, in the seas, and all deep places.
7. He causeth the vapors to ascend from the ends of the earth; He maketh lightning for the rain; He bringeth the wind out of his treasures.
8. Who smote the firstborn of Egypt, both of man and beast.
9. Who sent tokens and wonders into the midst of thee, O Egypt, upon Pharaoh, and upon all his servants.
10. Who smote great nations, and slew mighty kings.
11. Sihon king of the Amorites, and Og king of Bashan, and all the kingdoms of Canaan.
12. And gave their land for a heritage, a heritage unto Israel his people.
13. Thy Name, O Lord, endureth forever; and Thy memorial, O Lord, throughout all generations.
14. For the Lord will judge His people, and He will repent himself concerning His servants.
15. The idols of the heathen are silver and gold, the work of men's hands.
16. They have mouths, but they speak not; eyes have they, but they see not.
17. They have ears, but they hear not; neither is there any breath in their mouths.
18. They that make them are like unto them: so is everyone that trusteth in them.
19. Bless the Lord, O house of Israel: bless the Lord, O house of Aaron.
20. Bless the Lord, O house of Levi: ye that fear the Lord, bless the Lord.
21. Blessed be the Lord out of Zion, Who dwelleth at Jerusalem. Praise ye the Lord.

Here, the fully vested priest does the great censuring of the entire temple, including the festal icon. The priest uses the katzion (hand censer), but if none, the regular censer.

THE POLYELEOS, PART II: PSALM 135

End each verse with "Alleluia."

1. O give thanks unto the Lord; for He is good: for His mercy endureth forever.
2. O give thanks unto the God of gods: for His mercy endureth forever.
3. O give thanks to the Lord of lords: for His mercy endureth forever.
4. To Him Who alone doeth great wonders: for His mercy endureth forever.
5. To Him that by wisdom made the heavens: for His mercy endureth forever.
6. To Him that stretched out the earth above the waters: for His mercy endureth forever.
7. To Him that made great lights: for His mercy endureth forever.
8. The sun to rule by day: for His mercy endureth forever.
9. The moon and stars to rule by night: for His mercy endureth forever.
10. To Him that smote Egypt in their firstborn: for His mercy endureth forever.
11. And brought out Israel from among them: for His mercy endureth forever.
12. With a strong hand, and with a stretched out arm: for His mercy endureth forever.
13. To Him which divided the Red sea into parts: for His mercy endureth forever.
14. And made Israel to pass through the midst of it: for His mercy endureth forever.
15. But overthrew Pharaoh and his host in the Red Sea: for His mercy endureth forever.
16. To Him which led his people through the wilderness: for His mercy endureth forever.
17. To Him which smote great kings: for His mercy endureth forever.
18. And slew famous kings: for His mercy endureth forever.
19. Sihon king of the Amorites: for His mercy endureth forever.
20. And Og the king of Bashan: for His mercy endureth forever.
21. And gave their land for a heritage: for His mercy endureth forever.
22. Even a heritage unto Israel his servant: for His mercy endureth forever.
23. Who remembered us in our low estate: for His mercy endureth forever.

24. And hath redeemed us from our enemies: for His mercy endureth forever.
25. Who giveth food to all flesh: for His mercy endureth forever.
26. O give thanks unto the God of Heaven: for His mercy endureth forever.

TRIADIKON

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Let us worship the Father, and let us glorify the Son, and with one accord let us all praise the All-holy Spirit, whilst crying and saying: O All-holy Trinity, save us all.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Thy Mother do Thy people bring, before Thee in intercession, O Christ. By her supplications, grant us Thy compassions, O Good One, that we may glorify Thee, Who for our sake hast shone forth from her.

THE LITTLE LITANY

Deacon: Again and again, in peace, etc.

Priest: For blessed is thy name, and glorified is thy kingdom of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The deacon returns to his customary place in the sanctuary.

Third Kathisma in Tone Eight (**By conceiving the Wisdom**)

Thou wast filled with the wisdom received from Christ, * teaching us with this knowledge become thine own: * Devote all your energy, * soul and body unto the Lord, * seek the Spirit's enlivening grace; cleave ye to the light * that possesseth the power to cleanse you from passions' gloom. * Wherefore, as we honor * thee this day with rejoicing, * we beg thee, O Silouan, * righteous father whom Christ inspired: * Do thou preserve us by thy prayers, * make us grow in fear of God, * He Who granteth in His mercy everlasting riches unto all those who * draw nigh unto Him in faith.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. (repeat above)

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Groan and quake, O my soul, as thou takest thought * of the flame of Gehenna, the burning fire, * the weeping and mourning there, * the most woeful and bitterest * separation eternal from all of the company * and the portion and lot of the Saints in the age to come. * Strive, O soul, to blot out with thy tears of compunction * the writ of thine endless debts, * for thou hast as thy help a strong * fellow worker that cannot fail: * The Virgin who alone is pure, * through whom pardon of their sins is granted those * who glorify her with right faith * as the Mother of our God.

FESTAL ANABATHMOI IN TONE FOUR

- + From my youth do many passions war against me; but do Thou Thyself defend and save me, O my Saviour. (repeat)
- + Ye haters of Sion shall be shamed by the Lord; for, like grass, by the fire shall ye be withered. (repeat)
- + *Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.*
- + In the Holy Spirit every soul is quickened, and through cleansing is exalted and made

radiant by the Triple Unity in a hidden, sacred manner.

+ *Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.*

+ By the Holy Spirit, the streams of grace gush forth, watering all creation for the begetting of life.

PROKEIMENON FOR ST. SILOUAN IN TONE FOUR

With patience I waited patiently for the Lord, and He was attentive unto me, and He hearkened unto my supplication. (*twice*)

Stichos: *And He set my feet upon a rock, and He ordered my steps aright.*

With patience I waited patiently for the Lord, and He was attentive unto me, and He hearkened unto my supplication.

LET EVERYTHING THAT HATH BREATH

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

Priest: For holy art thou, O our God, who retest in the holies, and unto thee we ascribe glory, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

Let every breath praise the Lord. (*twice*)

Praise ye God in His saints, praise Him in the firmament of His power.

Let every breath praise the Lord.

THE FESTAL ORTHROS GOSPEL

Deacon: And that we may be accounted worthy to hear the Holy Gospel, let us beseech the Lord our God.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. (*thrice*)

Deacon: Wisdom! Stand upright! Let us hear the Holy Gospel.

Priest: Peace be to all.

Choir: And to thy spirit.

Priest: The reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint Luke (6:17-23).

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to Thee.

Deacon: Let us attend!

The priest reads the Gospel lesson from the holy doors.

Priest: At that time, Jesus stood on a level place, with a great crowd of his disciples and a great multitude of people from all Judea and Jerusalem and the seacoast of Tyre and Sidon, who came to hear him and to be healed of their diseases; and those who were troubled with unclean spirits were cured. And all the crowd sought to touch him, for power came forth from him and healed them all. And he lifted up his eyes on His disciples, and said: "Blessed are you poor, for yours is the Kingdom of God. Blessed are you that hunger now, for you shall be satisfied. Blessed are you that weep now, for you shall laugh. Blessed are you when men hate you, and

when they exclude you and revile you, and cast out your name as evil, on account of the Son of man! Rejoice in that day, and leap for joy, for behold, your reward is great in heaven.”

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to Thee.

There is no veneration of the Gospel book.

PSALM 50

Reader: Have mercy on me, O God, according to Thy Great Mercy; and according to the multitude of Thy compassions blot out my transgression. Wash me thoroughly from mine iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin. For I know mine iniquity, and my sin is ever before me. Against Thee only have I sinned and done this evil before Thee, that Thou mightest be justified in Thy words, and prevail when Thou art judged. For behold, I was conceived in iniquities, and in sins did my mother bear me. For behold, Thou hast loved truth; the hidden and secret things of Thy wisdom hast Thou made manifest unto me. Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop, and I shall be made clean; Thou shalt wash me, and I shall be made whiter than snow. Thou shalt make me to hear joy and gladness; the bones that be humbled, they shall rejoice. Turn Thy face away from my sins, and blot out all mine iniquities. Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a right spirit within me. Cast me not away from Thy presence, and take not Thy Holy Spirit from me. Restore unto me the joy of Thy salvation, and with Thy governing Spirit establish me. I shall teach transgressors Thy ways, and the ungodly shall turn back unto Thee. Deliver me from blood-guiltiness, O God, Thou God of my salvation; my tongue shall rejoice in Thy righteousness. O Lord, Thou shalt open my lips, and my mouth shall declare Thy praise. For if Thou hadst desired sacrifice, I had given it; with whole-burnt offerings Thou shalt not be pleased. A sacrifice unto God is a broken spirit; a heart that is broken and humbled God will not despise. Do good, O Lord, in Thy good pleasure unto Zion, and let the walls of Jerusalem be build up. Then shalt Thou be pleased with a sacrifice of righteousness, with oblation and whole-burnt offerings. Then shall they offer bullocks upon Thine altar.

FESTAL TROPARIA AFTER PSALM 50 IN TONE TWO

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

By the intercessions of our Holy Father Silouan, O Merciful One, blot out the multitude of mine offences.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

By the intercessions of the Theotokos, O Merciful One, blot out the multitude of mine offences.

(TONE SIX) *Have mercy upon me, O God, according to Thy great mercy, and according to the multitude of Thy compassions blot out my transgressions.*

Taking upon thee the lament of fallen Adam, O Father, thou didst put off corruption and conform thyself to Christ. Vouchsafe us also to put on Christ, by thine intercessions, O Silouan who hast looked upon God.

THE INTERCESSION

Priest: O God, save thy people, and bless thine inheritance. Visit thy world with mercy and compassions. Exalt the horn of Orthodox Christians and send down upon us thy rich mercies, through the intercessions of our all-immaculate Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary; by the might of the precious and life-giving cross; by the protection of the honorable bodiless powers of heaven; at the supplication of the honorable, glorious Prophet, Forerunner

and Baptist John; of the holy, glorious, all-laudable and foremost of the apostles, Peter and Paul, and of all the holy apostles; of our fathers among the saints, great hierarchs and ecumenical teachers Basil the Great, Gregory the Theologian and John Chrysostom; Athanasios, Cyril and John the Merciful, patriarchs of Alexandria; Nicholas of Myra in Lycia, Spyridon of Trimythous and Nektarios of Pentapolis, the wonder-workers; of our fathers among the saints Tikhon, patriarch of Moscow, and Raphael, bishop of Brooklyn; of the holy, glorious great martyrs George the Trophy-bearer, Demetrios the Myrrh-streaming, Theodore the Soldier, Theodore the General and Menas the Wonderworker; of the hieromartyrs Ignatius the God-bearer of Antioch, Charalampos and Eleftherios; of the holy, glorious and great women martyrs Thekla—whose memory we now celebrate—Barbara, Anastasia, Katherine, Kyriaki, Photini, Marina, Paraskeva and Irene; of the holy glorious and right-victorious martyrs; of our venerable and God-bearing fathers who shone in the ascetic life; of St Silouan the Athonite patron and protector of this holy community, whose memory we keep this day; of the holy and righteous ancestors of God, Joachim and Anna; of the Juvenaly & Peter the Aleut, New Martyrs of Alaska, whose memory we celebrate; and of all thy saints,: have mercy on us and save us, forasmuch as He is good and loveth mankind.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. (*twelve times*)

Priest: Through the mercy and compassions and love for mankind of thine only-begotten Son, with whom thou art blessed, together with thine all-holy and good and life-giving Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

THE CANON

ODE ONE

(*chanted*)

Fourth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Having set thy desire on God, O most blessed Father Silouan, thou didst seek Him with thirst; and having found Him, thou didst cleave to Him, and by Him thou hast declared things which are not to be spoken.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

The heart of every man is the dwelling-place of God, thus Jesus said; and therein, O Silouan, thou didst find thy heart's desire, having cast off every doubt and every unbelief.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

In a vision thou didst foreshow to Silouan his appointed course, and thou didst call him to his holy calling; and the fruit of thy womb consumed him with the fire of love, and joined him to the ranks of the ascetics of old.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Love bound thee to God, O wise and excellent Silouan, and thou didst clearly know what is that love, and impartest it freely to such as turn to thee.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Christ saw thy thirsting soul, O Saint, and filled it with the water of His love; and by the Holy Spirit, He showed thee plainly the mystery of His incarnation.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Jesus poureth His love upon all that seek His divine mercy in faith; who are drawn to Him, and who cleave to Him as to a most gracious God.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

When he considered thy glory, O pure Virgin, Silouan was drawn unresisting by the Spirit unto God, and he now entreateth that the people which the Lord hath fashioned may come to know His power.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

I shall open my mouth to chant and with the Spirit shall I be filled, and words shall I now pour forth unto the Mother and Queen; and I shall be seen in joyous jubilation, acclaiming exultantly all of her wondrous deeds.

ODE THREE

(chanted)

Fourth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Christ kindled the piety which thy father had laid in thee, O Saint: for natural disposition met with grace, and thus conjoined made of thee a resplendent work of God.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Knowing that time spent without remembrance of God profiteth nothing, thou didst straightway put thy hand to the plough, O Silouan, having good conscience as thy goad.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

A youthful fall became thy ladder unto God, O Father; for thou didst keep in mind that thou hadst grieved Him once, and thereafter didst greatly rejoice Him by thy repentance.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

Thou didst come to the young Silouan in a dream, O Virgin, to sow in him the spirit of repentance, wondrously calling him to do those things that are pleasing unto God, and to perform His will.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

The spirit of prayer cannot exist in a proud mind, declareth Silouan, but grace to pray is given to the lowly who do the will of God.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

The heart is united to the mind by prayer without distraction and by simplicity of life; and when it is grown humble through God's watering, it is made one with Christ by grace.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

By the Holy Spirit Christ is revealed to the soul; and in His love He rejoiceth to reign in her, and to gladden her wondrously as a bride that He hath chosen.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Appease thy Son, O all-blameless Mother; and as thou didst grant his prayer to Silouan, so by thine intercessions grant the petitions of thy supplicants.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

Make steadfast, O holy Theotokos, thou living and never-failing spring, all them that form a company and gather for to praise thy name; and by thy grace divine, O Maid, deem them all worthy of glory's crowns.

THE LITTLE LITANY

Deacon: Again and again, in peace, etc.

Priest: For Thou art our God and to Thee we send up glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

SESSIONAL HYMNS

Third Mode. (**Awed by the beauty**)

Thy deep repentance was beautiful to behold * before the face of God, Who richly thus bestowed * His divine mercy as reward for thy courage in thy struggles, * and He clearly made Himself * known to thee, righteous Silouan; * thereby He established thee * as a teacher for all mankind; * thus leading nigh our souls to the Spirit * by Whom thou wast made to shine with wisdom.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. (repeat above)

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Awed by the beauty of thy virginity * and the exceeding radiance of thy purity, * Gabriel called out unto thee, O Theotokos: * What worthy hymn of praise * can I offer unto thee? * And what shall I name thee? * I am in doubt and stand in awe. * Wherefore, as commanded, I cry to thee: * Rejoice, O Full of Grace.

ODE FOUR
(plain reading)

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Repentance overwhelmed thy soul like a river, O Father, and the hour of judgment was set before thine eyes, and yearning was kindled for the monastic life, whereby each one that keepeth the commandments findeth salvation.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Saint John, wise pastor of Kronstadt, strengthened thee to forsake the world; for through his prayers thou didst feel the flames of hell whose burning pursued thee to Mount Athos.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

With but a word, O Father, thou didst preserve thy soul from the dogs: for by experience thou knewest the power of calling upon the name of the Lord; for by His name the demons are kept far off, and the Prince of peace is established in the heart.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

The favor of the Mother of God encompassed thee, O blessed Silouan, and called thee to dwell upon Mount Athos, and there enjoy the promises which were given her by her most dear son.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Unceasing contrition of heart is a great preserver of grace, and mindfulness of hell an uprooter of despair from the soul: so thou teachest us, O Father.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Grace is given to the lowly of mind, and through tears it flourisheth divinely; and the soul is made into paradise, and arrayed in the robe of godhood.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Perfect knowledge of the mysteries of the Godhead cometh from the Holy Spirit, and the soul perceiveth the merciful Jesus; so Silouan hath declared of his own knowledge.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O most holy Virgin, thou art high above all creatures; for by humility thou becamest a Mother of Him that is lowly; wherefore, thou lovest the humble and makest them friends of thy Lord.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

When the Prophet Habakkuk, O Thou Most High, learned of the divine and untraceable counsel of Thy pure incarnation from the womb of the blest Virgin, he cried out: Glory to Thy power, O Lord my God.

ODE FIVE

(plain reading)

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thou didst run to dwell upon Mount Athos, and within his fold the great martyr Panteleimon gave thee courage to be obedient as a good soldier of Christ, thy conscience bearing a good witness.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thou didst live peaceably in the Lord, O Saint, receiving perfect forgiveness of thy transgressions; and when the enemy strongly assailed thee, thou didst drive him away, saying, I will die here for my sins.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

The Lord looked graciously on thy soul, O Father, and gave thee His mother for thy teacher and effectual guide in prayer; but the hater and envier of good tormented thee with the voice of wicked spirits.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

O pure Virgin, leave me not to withstand alone the evil one, for he stirreth up a great struggle past my strength; but go before me, O Lady, with Saint Silouan, and lighten my darkened way.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

He that loveth to do his own will shall drive far from his soul the peace which the Spirit imparteth; so Silouan, the dwelling place of peace, teacheth from knowledge.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Peace entereth the soul through love and by knowledge of the Word of God, and Christ the Prince of peace then ruleth within her; so saith Silouan by the Spirit.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

The soul that is strengthened by the Spirit cried from the depths: Give peace to Thy people, I pray Thee, O Lord, that they may be satisfied with the beauty of Thy face.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Most pure Lady, thou hast borne the Physician of our souls and procurer of our peace, Who by the mercy of the Cross gathereth into one the divided powers of the soul.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

All creatures were sore amazed at thy divine and great glory, Maid, O pure Virgin, who hast not known wed lock; for thou didst hold in thy womb the God of all, and gavest birth to the timeless Son, Who doth grant salvation unto all them that acclaim thy name.

ODE SIX

(plain reading)

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

When wicked spirits warred against thee, thou didst learn well their hatred of man; and once, despairing, thou didst say, God will not hear me; but the merciful Lord was swift to manifest His help.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Lo, Christ, the precious Bread of Life, appeared to thee at the mill, O Saint, and by the Holy Spirit ineffably filled thy being with the knowledge of God.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thou didst commune with fire, which Christ incarnate brought on the earth and which bedeweth all; and thou was filled with light, O Saint, as were the Holy Apostles on Mount Tabor.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

If a man inhabit the world of the Holy Spirit, he hath another understanding of spiritual truth and is made godlike while yet on earth; this, O Bride of God, is the substance of Silouan's teachings.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

O good Comforter, Thou didst find a pure vessel in Silouan wise in God, and didst fill him with grace to bear witness of Thee, enabling him to apprehend spiritual truths and to thirst beyond measure to suffer for Christ.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

My fearful soul is fallen from grace, and in grief she crieth out: Leave me not comfortless, O Good Comforter, for Thou truly art my life, and without Thee there is only death.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

The whole earth, O Lord, is full of Thy mercy, whereby every creature is given life and drawn to follow Thee, and groweth unto perfection nourished like a sheep by grace.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O Mary all-undefiled, tell thy people of thy love for Christ, and how through prayer, thou couldst endure the parting when thou didst see Him ascend to the Father.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

On this divine and most honoured feast of God's all-holy Mother, let all of godly mind now celebrate; come let us faithful now clap our hands, and send up glory unto the God Whom she hath borne.

THE LITTLE LITANY

Deacon: Again and again, in peace, etc.

Priest: For Thou art the King of Peace and the Savior of our souls and to Thee we ascribe glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

KONTAKION AND OIKOS FOR ST. SILOUAN (Plain Reading)

During thy life on earth thou didst serve Christ, following His path, and now in Heaven thou dost contemplate Him Whom thou hast loved; dwelling with Him as He promised to His elect, O Holy Father Silouan, instruct us in the way that thou hast gone.

Having known the most sweet Jesus, the holy disciples said unto Him: For that we have been shown the beauty of love, and reckon any other life as nothing, O Lord, whither shall we go? Whom else shall we follow? We have been filled past speech with Thy life, and without Thee we cannot live. And in the last times Silouan hath followed their example and astonished the whole world by his most holy life. For by a miracle he saw Christ, and by experience of grace knew mysteries. Now he leadeth to the love of God the peoples of the earth, for whom he ever prayeth, that they may be filled with the knowledge of God and become partakers of the Holy Spirit. Wherefore with one voice we cry out to him as our teacher: O Holy Father Silouan, instruct us in the way that thou hast gone.

SYNAXARION

On the twenty-fourth of this month we commemorate our venerable Father Silouan of Mount Athos.

Saint Silouan, that citizen of the heavenly Jerusalem, was born of pious parents in the land of Russia in the village of Shovsk in the diocese of the Metropolitan of Tambov. He came into the world in the year of our Lord 1866, and from a young man was called to repentance by the All-Praised Mother of God and ever-Virgin Mary.

When he had reached his twenty-seventh year, he renounced the things of this life, and, with the prayers of Saint John of Kronstadt to speed him on his way, he set forth for Greece and the illustrious Holy Mountain. Here, in the monastery of the Holy Great Martyr and Physician Panteleimon, he took upon him the yoke of the monastic life.

Thus he gave himself to God with all his soul, and in a brief while he not only received the gift of unceasing prayer from the Most Holy Mother of God, but was also granted ineffably to see the living Christ in the chapel of the Holy Prophet Elijah that was next to the monastery's flour mill.

But this first grace was taken away, and the saint was constrained by anguish and great grief, and with God's permission for fifteen years he was given over to manifold temptations of spiritual foes, and so he followed in the footsteps of Christ, having offered up prayers and strong supplications with strong crying and tears unto Him that was able to save him from death (Heb. 5:7), being taught by God through a voice from above that gave him this commandment: "Keep thy mind in hell, and despair not." This he observed as an infallible rule, and so ran the way of Anthony, Makarios, Poemen and Sisoës, and the other celebrated preceptors and fathers of the desert, to whose measure and spiritual gifts he also attained, and was manifested an apostolic and inspired teacher both living and after death.

For he left behind him writings filled with the Holy Spirit and with grace. These were published by his pupil and disciple Staretz Sophrony, the founder and archimandrite of the Holy Stavropegic Monastery of Saint John the Baptist in the British Isles. And, indeed, what need is there here of more words concerning the most Holy Silouan? For this holy Archimandrite Sophrony hath already set forth and expounded perfectly the Saint's life and doctrine in his preface to the book wherein he enshrined Silouan's life and comforting words; which book teacheth, as he that readeth may see and understand, that this spiritual warrior came unto the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ (Eph 4:13); that by a perfect keeping of the commandments he who was dead to this life had Christ living in him, as Saint Paul saith (Gal 2:19-20), and that he was made a divinely inspired and living book for others, written by the pen of the Spirit. And many, out of every nation under heaven, put their trust in his teaching and thereby have come, and still come to this day, unto the knowledge of the Truth.

For the saint was wondrously meek and lowly in heart, a fervent advocate before God for the salvation of all, and unequaled among teachers: For he says that there is no surer proof that the divine Spirit dwells within us than that we love our enemies.

This blessed Saint Silouan passed over from death to life, full of spiritual days on the Eleventh day of September in the year of our Lord Jesus Christ 1938: To Whom be glory and might forever and ever. Amen.

By the intercessions of our Venerable Father Silouan, O Christ our God, have mercy on us and

save us. Amen.

ODE SEVEN

(chanted)

Fourth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thou didst taste the goodness of the merciful Lord, O Saint, and He poured abundance of life ineffably on thee. Wherefore, thou didst cry: O God of our fathers, Thou Thyself hast visited me.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thy life is a pattern for such as would receive the power of the Spirit; and as we endeavor to follow in that way, we glorify God Who hath shown thee forth as a great witness of His compassion.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thy repentance was mighty and unspeakable, O wondrous father Silouan, for thou didst study to grieve no more the lovingkindness of the Lord, and didst acquire peace of conscience through thy great love for Him.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

There is but hell and destruction, O Lady, away from true life, the Fruit of thy womb. Wherefore, intercede that He depart not from my heart, but will gladden my whole life forever.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

The free soul is made known when she doeth God's commandments; and her spirit is strengthened by grace, and layeth aside earthly cares, throwing down the brazen wall of self-will.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

When humility dwelleth in the soul, the turmoil of the thoughts is stilled, and thankfulness wellet up to God Who taketh thought for us, and pardoneth His people that repent of their transgressions.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

The heart endureth affliction, the more it loveth God. But when it perceiveth His sweetness, it runneth without ceasing that it may obtain; for all earthly pleasure is naught in comparison thereof.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Conforming thyself to the will of thy Son, O Virgin, thou hadst strength to endure the sword,

even His Cross and death. Wherefore, like thee, we all cry to God: Behold my soul which is thy handmaid; be it unto me as is expedient.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

No created thing, but only the Creator would the godly-minded Youths adore and worship as God; but manfully trampling down threats of fire, they cried out: O supremely-praised and all-acclaimed One, blest art Thou, O Thou Lord God of our Fathers.

ODE EIGHT

Fourth Tone

(chanted)

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

There is no end to virtue, for the invisible God is sought; wherefore, O sacred Father, in that time thou wast abandoned, when grace was taken from thee, thou didst run thy race in fear, and with godly labors didst seek the more Him Whom thou didst love.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thou wast granted humility, O Saint inspired of God, without which there is no fruitful prayer, and as saving despair, the descent of the mind into hell; and following in faith the way of the fathers, thou hast attained to the measure of Saint Antony.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

The most good Lord, willing to make salvation easy for mortal men, hath given us His likeness upon earth: our neighbor, through whom we are raised up to union with Him. Thus Silouan teacheth in his writings, for he himself lived in brotherly love.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

That he might reprove the foolish wisdom of the world, O Virgin, Christ gave the fishers the wisdom of the Spirit; and thy servant Silouan partook of that same wisdom, and shone forth upon the world radiant as the sun, making those in darkness receivers of the light.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

How great is Thy grace, O most-merciful Lord! Thou dost cleanse from sin those that have fallen from Thee, and grantest thy people the Holy Spirit and the sweetness of Thy forgiveness, as Silouan teacheth.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Knowledge of God cometh from faith; and the grace of the Holy Spirit hath given mortal men to draw near Him from experience, but this is the way of the perfect alone.

We bless Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, the Lord.

The heart of Adam our first father wove a song of lamentation when he pondered the greatness of the Lord and ever remembered his sins and longed for the grace that was his perpetually in paradise.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O virgin who makest intercession for the world, keep me free from sin by thy prayers, for I know the height of thy love and how great is thy boldness toward thy tender Son.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

We praise, we bless, and we worship the Lord.

Three guiltless Youths cast in the furnace were saved by the Offspring which the Theotokos bare, then in figure and in type, now in very truth and deed; and He hath gathered all the world, which crieth out in chant: Ye works of His, O sing the Lord's praises, and exalt Him greatly for ages and all ages.

The deacon faces the icon of the Theotokos from the side of the holy doors and gestures to it with his orarion.

Deacon: The Theotokos and Mother of Light let us honor and magnify in song.

Receiving the blessing from the priest, the deacon begins a great censuring of the entire temple, beginning with the sanctuary and returning thereto.

MAGNIFICATIONS IN TONE FOUR

Choir: My soul doth magnify the Lord, and my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Savior.

Refrain: More honorable than the cherubim, and more glorious beyond compare than the seraphim, thou who without corruption didst bear God the Word, and art truly Theotokos: we magnify thee. *(Repeat after each verse.)*

- + For He hath regarded the lowliness of His handmaiden; for behold from henceforth all generations shall call me blessed. *(Refrain)*
- + For He that is mighty hath magnified me, and holy is His Name; and His mercy is on them that fear Him, throughout all generations. *(Refrain)*
- + He hath showed strength with His arm; He hath scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts. *(Refrain)*
- + He hath put down the mighty from their seat, and hath exalted the humble and meek. He hath filled the empty with good things, and the rich hath He sent empty away. *(Refrain)*
- + He remembering His mercy hath helped His servant Israel, as He promised to our forefathers, Abraham and his seed forever. *(Refrain)*

ODE NINE

(chanted)

Fourth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Come unto the people of God, O most holy Silouan, give ear to Adam's lament; lift up thy hands

and bend thy knee, and by thy prayers pour forth the all-holy Spirit upon them that yearn for Him, and who offer thee as mediator before the Lord and the Son.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Thou standest now where stand the choirs of Angels, and beholdest clearly divine mysteries, which in the world thou didst see as in a glass; and thou prayest together with the communion of all the saints, O beloved saint, whose heart melted for love of God.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

Inspired like the Prophets, thou hast newly outstripped the fathers of old; by thy way of life thou hast illumined the ends of the world, and by the words of thy teachings made hearts mount up to things above the earth. Wherefore, we all venerate thy memorial.

Most Holy Theotokos, save us!

Hearken unto me, thou Queen of the Holy Mountain, and reject me not; for I am the abomination of desolation, wretched man that I am; but, taking courage, I offer fervent prayers and cry to thee: O Lady, as once thou gavest help to Silouan, give succor also unto me.

Second Canon. Sixth Tone

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

It is not possible for men to see the glory of God and of His saints, if they have fleshly minds and eyes darkened by the passions, for the gifts of grace cannot be given except the soul be cleansed.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

O Jesus, give unto Thy servants the strength of grace, at the prayers of Saint Silouan, who was vouchsafed grace of Thee, and as a great intercessor before Thy throne, hath shown the world that Thou art a merciful God.

O Venerable Father Silouan, pray to God for us!

What am I to say, who have no contrition, when I consider all the perfection of thy life, O Father, whereby thou didst find humility which is the fulness of grace, and wast made like Him that is meek and lowly of heart, from Whom I am gone astray.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

The relics of the saints well forth divine grace upon us, each time we draw nigh them in faith, and from this we plainly feel and know that thou also, O Silouan, hast partaken of perfect love.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O pure Lady, satisfy my continual thirst and yearning for thy most sweet Son, for in Him shall I find deliverance from sin, and through Him, as Silouan affirmeth, the most Holy Spirit is given.

KATAVASIA

Fourth Tone

Let every earthborn man upleap in the spirit, and now hold his torch on high; and let all the bodiless noetic hosts now celebrate joyously the Theotokos's sublime and sacred festival, as they cry out: Rejoice, O thou all-blessed one, Ever-virgin and pure Mother of our God.

THE LITTLE LITANY

Deacon: Again and again, in peace, etc.

Priest: For all the powers of heaven praise Thee, and unto Thee do they ascribe glory, to the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

THE EXAPOSTEILARIA AND THEOTOKION FOR ST. SILOUAN IN TONE TWO

*(**Upon that mount in Galilee**)*

O blessed father Silouan, * rich gifts the Spirit gave thee, * with which thou leddest multitudes * unto the gracious Savior. * For thy words sweeten like honey * all who have set their whole heart * steadfastly on the Love of God * and who thirst after Christ with their soul and mind, * seeking after Him in the Holy Spirit. * Wherefore, as thy disciples, we * honor and magnify thee.

*(**While thy disciples**)*

Knowing the Lord, O Silouan, by the light of * the Spirit, thou didst make thine abode in that light, * which became for thee a rich inheritance. * Thereby, hast thou enlightened all, * even the world's farthest regions * with the clear light of thy teachings.

In thee do we all boast, O pure Theotokos; * with God, we all possess thee as our protection. * Stretch forth thine invincible and mighty hand, * smite to the ground our enemies; * and send forth unto thy servants * quick help from God, the All-holy.

AINOI (Praises) IN TONE EIGHT

Choir: Let everything that hath breath praise the Lord. Praise ye the Lord from the heavens; praise Him in the heights. To Thee, O God, is due our song.

Choir: Praise ye Him, all His angels; praise ye Him, all His hosts. To Thee, O God, is due our song.

For St Silouan in Tone Eight (**O strange wonder**)

Verse 1. Praise ye God in His saints; praise Him in the firmament of His power. Praise Him for His mighty acts; praise Him according to the multitude of His greatness.

O our wondrous father Silouan, * equal in honor to those * radiant fathers who taught of old. * O thou universal light * and wise teacher for all world: * a new Apostle filled with the Spirit's grace. * Thou who hast rivaled the martyrs in thy love, * boast of the Holy Church, * in the Spirit standing in the sight of God, * intercede thou ceaselessly for those who honor thee.

Verse 2. Praise Him with the sound of trumpet; praise Him with the psalter and harp.

O our wondrous father Silouan, * thou wast made like unto Christ, * as the Spirit acquainted thee * with His boundless mercy and * made His kindness know unto thee. * Thus, intercede that all nations may obtain * the knowledge of their Creator and their God, * asking that we may find * Him Who is past nature, even Christ the Word, * the eternal Treasure and the sweetness of our souls.

Verse 3. *Praise Him with timbrel and dance; praise him with stringed instruments and organs.*

Love of God is the fulfillment of the law, * it is the triumph of Grace. * And receiving that very love * in the secret of thy heart, * by adoption wast thou remade * like unto God; and thereby thou offrest up * as whole-burnt offerings and endless sacrifice, * prayer without measure and * boundless tears; all which the Lord God hath received * as an incense pure and sweet * and given thee a crown.

Verse 4. *Praise Him upon the loud cymbals; praise Him upon the high-sounding cymbals. Let everything that hath breath praise the Lord.*

Truly thou didst understand aright * the height of knowledge, to wit: * that humility is the path * whereby every man is clothed * in the nature that is divine. * For likewise thou wast united to the Lord, * and though amidst a great multitude of monks, * thou dweltest in the depths * of the inner desert, offering praise to God. * Wherefore, we all praise thy name, O righteous Silouan.

THE DOXASTICON FOR ST. SILOUAN IN TONE FIVE

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Great is thy mercy, O thrice-holy Lord! And how shall we worthily declare thy power? For Thou hast created us anew by thy Holy Spirit; and though we, like the prodigal son, had strayed far from our Father's house, Thou didst bring us back again and clothe us in purple and the robe of grace. And by his sublime teachings, Silouan is a new witness to us of Thy gifts of grace. Wherefore, taking our words from him, in wonder we entreat Thee: Give to Thy people the saving knowledge of Thee; bestow on them Thine ineffable love, that all we in unity may glorify Thee our Creator forevermore. For Thou art the Friend of man and hast vouchsafed us to be made in Thine own image.

THEOTOKION IN TONE FIVE

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

We the faithful bless thee, O Virgin Theotokos, and we glorify thee, as is meet and proper: O unshaken city, impregnable battlement, invincible protection, and sheltering refuge for our souls.

All the lights in the church are illumined. The priest now censes the holy table, the sanctuary and the iconostasis, and then the church and people from the bema.

THE GREAT DOXOLOGY IN TONE FIVE

- + Glory to Thee, Who hast shown forth the light. Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, good will among men.
- + We praise Thee, we bless Thee, we worship Thee, we glorify Thee, we give thanks to Thee for Thy great glory.
- + O Lord King, heavenly God, Father almighty; O Lord, the only-begotten Son, Jesus Christ;

and O Holy Spirit.

- + O Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father, that takest away the sin of the world: have mercy on us, thou who takest away the sins of the world.
- + Receive our prayer, Thou who sittest at the right hand of the Father, and have mercy on us.
- + For Thou alone art holy, Thou alone art the Lord, Jesus Christ, to the glory of God the Father. Amen.
- + Every day will I bless Thee, and I will praise Thy name forever, and unto the ages of ages.
- + Vouchsafe, O Lord, to keep us this day without sin.
- + Blessed art Thou, O Lord, the God of our Fathers, and praised and glorified is Thy name unto the ages. Amen.
- + Let Thy mercy be upon us, O Lord, even as we have hoped in thee.
- + Blessed art Thou, O Lord; teach me Thy statutes. (thrice)
- + Lord, thou hast been our refuge from generation to generation. I said: O Lord, have mercy on me; heal my soul, for I have sinned against Thee.
- + O Lord, to Thee have I fled for refuge; teach me to do Thy will, for Thou art my God.
- + For in Thee is the fountain of life; in Thy light we shall see light.
- + Continue Thy mercy unto those who know thee.
- + Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal: have mercy on us. (thrice)
- + Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
- + Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.
- + Holy Immortal: have mercy on us.
- + Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal: have mercy on us.

APOLYTIKION OF ST. SILOUAN IN TONE FOUR

By prayer thou didst receive Christ as thy teacher in the way of humility, and the Spirit bore witness to salvation in thy heart. Wherefore, all peoples called unto hope rejoice in this day of thy memorial, O sacred Father Silouan. Pray unto Christ our God for the salvation of our souls.